

Rolling LED Ceiling Screens

Banners are dead. This is the attention machine.

What It Is

A supply-and-install business for rolling LED screens — motorized digital displays that drop down from the ceiling and turn an entire space into a moving, glowing advertisement. They make any venue look futuristic and people can't stop filming them. You source the hardware, then sell, install, and rent these to luxury stores, malls, restaurants, showrooms, airports, and events.

How It Makes Money

Three revenue streams: outright sale of the screen plus install, monthly rental for events and pop-ups, and recurring service/content contracts (you manage what plays on them). Buyers are businesses that compete on "wow" — retail, hospitality, real estate showrooms, and event producers who want viral, attention-grabbing spaces.

Startup Costs

- First demo screen unit from Alibaba (rolling/flexible LED): \$1,500–\$6,000
- Controller, mounting rig, and motorized roller: \$300–\$1,200
- Install tools and basic rigging gear: \$200–\$600
- Liability insurance for installs: \$400–\$900/yr
- Demo reel, website, and product photos: \$200–\$600
- Business registration and licensing: \$150–\$500
- Total to launch: **\$2,500–\$9,000** (one demo unit you can show and rent immediately)

The Numbers

A rolling LED unit lands from Alibaba at roughly **\$1,500–\$6,000** depending on size and resolution. You sell installed packages at **\$5,000–\$15,000+**, a markup of **\$3,000–\$9,000 per sale** after install labor. Rentals run **\$500–\$2,000 per event** and the same screen rents many times. Close 3 sales a month at \$4,000 profit each = **\$12,000/month**, plus rental income from your demo units. Add content-management retainers (\$200–\$500/mo each) for recurring revenue.

How To Start

1. Order one demo screen from Alibaba and learn to install, program, and load content on it.
2. Film a jaw-dropping demo reel of the screen rolling down and playing in a real-looking space.
3. Build a simple site and pricing tiers: buy, rent, and managed-content options.
4. Offer the first few installs at cost to get reference venues and footage.
5. Line up a reliable installer or AV contractor to scale beyond what you can mount yourself.
6. Sell rentals to events to generate cash while you close higher-ticket sales.
7. Upsell content-management retainers so each install becomes recurring revenue.

Where To Get Customers

Target retail chains, luxury boutiques, restaurants, real-estate showrooms, and event/AV companies with direct outreach and your demo reel. Post install footage on Instagram, TikTok, and LinkedIn — the screens are inherently viral, so the content sells itself. Exhibit at retail and event-industry trade shows. Partner with interior designers and shopfitters who spec fixtures for new builds.

Pro Tips

- **Lead with one killer demo reel.** Buyers purchase the reaction, not specs — a 20-second clip of the screen rolling down closes more deals than any brochure.
- **Bundle content management.** Selling the screen is one-time; managing what plays on it turns every client into monthly recurring revenue.
- **Rent before they buy.** A short event rental lets hesitant venues experience the wow factor, then upsell them into a permanent install.